issued a total of 1,758 populist-style tweets over our period of analysis, while IMF officials sent 675 populist-style tweets. Our classification algorithm also detected higher populist-style tweet activity on average from senior officials such as IMF managing director Kristalina Georgieva and World Bank senior managing director Axel van Trotsenburg.

Figure 7.1 illustrates the proportion of tweets classified as populist-style by year. Our findings reveal that IOs' adoption of people-centric rhetoric corresponds with global trends in populism. IOs have increasingly adopted populist-style messaging alongside an increase in the number of populist leaders and parties (Kyle and Meyer 2020). The proportion of IO tweets that use populist-style language peaks in 2018, which corresponds to the height of populist leadership in the world. Our descriptive findings suggest that IOs employ populist-style rhetoric in their tweets in practice and that this communication strategy corresponds with the rise and decline of populist leadership around the world.